

Now 5 billion years old, the Universe consists of vast clusters of galaxies, separated by gigantic voids

When the Universe is about 8 billion years old, its expansion starts to accelerate

As they evolve and merge, galaxies grow larger and develop spiral structures

The Solar System is beginning to form in a Universe that is now about 9 billion years old

Around 13.8 billion years after the Big Bang, the Universe has reached its present size

The Universe is expected to carry on expanding forever



△ Evolving galaxies

Looking deep into space also means peering far back in time towards the Big Bang. This Hubble Space Telescope image shows galaxies that are at greatly varying distances and so belong to different times in the evolution of the Universe. The more distant galaxies, from some of the earliest times, appear as fuzzy blobs.